

PURPOSE: For MSMS to switch from a semester schedule to a trimester schedule.

INTRODUCED BY: Sabrina Sims

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS AND SCIENCE SENATE:

SECTION ONE (DEFINITIONS):

Semester: An 18-week academic period

Trimester: A 12-week academic period.

SECTION TWO (REASONING):

At MSMS students must earn a minimum of 13 Carnegie units, however, most students exceed this by taking “elective” classes such as organic chemistry and film. Many students do not get to participate in all the classes they originally desired to when coming to MSMS. Trimesters would allow students to take more classes overall and have fewer classes per academic period, allowing them to focus more on each class. Considering A days alone, rather than up to 8 classes during fall and spring semesters students could have up to 6 classes during fall, winter, and spring trimesters. This raises the number of classes a student could take from 16 to 18.

SECTION THREE (APPENDIX):

Response 1 (Anonymous):

“With trimesters I feel that I could have been less stressed about trying to make sure I got all of my required classes and gotten more of the MSMS experience that is advertised.”

Response 2 (Anonymous):

“Personally, my junior year was almost unbearable! When I received my schedule from the counselors I already did not have a lunch (not my choice)! Having trimesters would have spread out my classes and lightened the load a lot. I also would have been able to take classes this year that I did not get to due to overlapping classes. I did not get to take the one class I was looking forward to this year due to this problem. Moving to trimesters students can take the classes they came to MSMS to take.”

Response 3 (Mrs. Z):

“So, I do believe that a lot of MSMS students have too many courses that they have to keep up with at one time. Schedules like a trimester schedule or a quarter schedule where we can reduce the number of classes at one time do seem beneficial to that end. The problem is when courses need to happen one after the other like the algebra sequence in math sometimes those gaps created by a trimester or quarter system serve to hurt kids because they can’t have everything in a row, and they really need everything in a row.”